

A It is likely that your system is getting overheated, and there are a few things you need to do. Open your cabinet and see if all the cooling fans (processor, cabinet ventilation, power supply, and graphics card—if it has one) are running. It is always a good idea to clean the fans and also the heat sinks of the CPU and the graphics card, which are prone to accumulating heaps of dust. Using a paintbrush to clean them should suffice. Remove the memory modules from the slots and brush the slots and contact areas. If you can, remove the heat sink from the CPU, clean it, and apply a fresh thin coat of heat sink compound to it before fixing it back. Cables in your PC cabinet being cluttered may be a hindrance to proper ventilation. Tie up the cables so that air flows freely. Don't place the cabinet close to a wall, as this could block ventilation.

Defragmenting your hard drive(s) will most likely solve your problem with the audio and video. It is good practice to defragment your drive(s) once a fortnight. Also, just in case, install the latest drivers for your sound as well as video card.

Media Madness

Q In Windows Media Player, I often receive an error that states "Specified module not found." It pops up whenever I try to play any type of media file, be it MP3 or AVI or DAT. I had WMP 9 and I installed WMP 10, but the problem persists. I have DirectX 9.0c installed.

Karthik K T G

A You can first try downloading and installing VLC Media Player from www.videolan.org, or from the *Digit* CD. This player can play most types of audio and video files without even the need for installing codecs.

To get to the root of your problem with WMP, run the DirectX diagnostic tool by typing in "DXDIAG" at a command prompt. In the dialog that appears, select the Display tab; under the "Notes" header, you should see "No problems found", otherwise do as suggested in the message there. If you see "No problems found", you may need to downgrade WMP to a lower version such as 7. If the problem goes away, you can later update WMP to the latest version from the *Digit* CD/DVD. If this fails as well, you may need to repair your Windows XP installation (assuming you're running XP) from the XP Recovery Console (Refer *Digit* September 2006). You will not lose any file settings and will not need to reinstall any applications.

You're Locked Out!

Q I installed Folder Lock 5.0 to hide certain important files and folders. I've forgotten the password I had set. Is there any way to retrieve the files?

Amlan Mohapatra

A Sorry, there is no way to access files protected by Folder Lock 5.0 other than by providing the original password!

Preview Pane Problems

Q I am using Windows XP Professional. When I open the Display Properties to change my desktop wallpaper and click on a JPG, GIF or HTM file in the list, I am not able to view the preview of my Desktop with the image as the wallpaper.

Rahil Ahmad

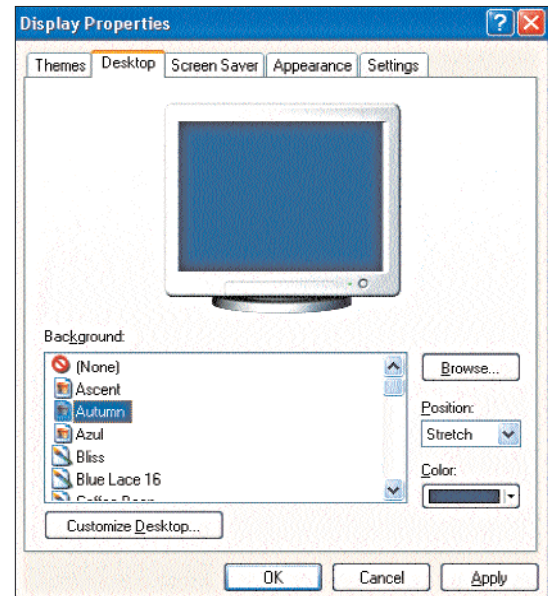


Image preview is not available in the Display Properties

A Type in the following commands at a command prompt:

```
REGSVR32 /i SHIMGVW.DLL
REGSVR32 /i MSHTML.DLL
```

Close and reopen the Display Properties dialog. If the problem persists, or if the Preview Pane turns white when you select a wallpaper, then run this command:

```
REGSVR32 /i SHELL32.DLL
```

You should be able to preview the wallpaper.

Playing Cops And Robbers

Q If a GSM mobile phone is stolen, is there any way to block it from being used?

Nilesh Bansal

A The first thing you need to do if your phone is lost or has been stolen is to contact your mobile service provider and ask them to block your number. To block your phone from being used from any network at all, you must have its IMEI number. The IMEI number is a 15-digit serial number that is unique to each wireless instrument.

To find out your IMEI number on your GSM phone, key in * # 0 6 # and the IMEI number will appear on your screen. You can give this number to the service provider and also to the police station you have contacted. This will ensure that your mobile phone cannot be used, and that it can be tracked even if the SIM card has been changed.